

Green Valley Community Hospital

Medical Records Office

Patient Records and Document Request Policy

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Purpose

This policy explains how patients can request a copy of their administrative hospital records at Green Valley Community Hospital, what identification is needed, and how corrections can be requested. It describes simple, fictional privacy rules and does not represent real-world legal requirements.

The policy is meant to give patients a clear, predictable path for accessing their own administrative information, while keeping that information protected from unauthorized access.

Scope

This policy applies to patients requesting a copy of their own administrative records, and to authorized representatives requesting records on behalf of a patient.

It applies specifically to administrative records. Requests for detailed clinical notes follow a separate process managed by the treating clinical department, since those records involve additional clinical context.

Patient Administrative Records

Green Valley Community Hospital keeps basic administrative records for each patient, including registration details, admission and discharge dates, billing statements, and general visit history. These administrative records are separate from detailed clinical notes, which are handled by clinical departments and are outside the scope of this policy.

Requesting Records

A patient requesting a copy of their administrative record should provide identification and complete the hospital's record request form, available at the Medical Records Office or the Administrative Services Desk.

Record Request Steps

- 1 Complete the record request form, including the patient reference number if known.
- 2 Provide identification confirming the requester's identity.
- 3 Submit the form to the Medical Records Office in person, by mail, or by email.
- 4 The Medical Records Office reviews the request and prepares the requested record.

Identity Verification

To protect patient information, the Medical Records Office verifies the identity of anyone requesting a record. Patients requesting their own record should present a valid identification document matching the name on file.

Authorized Representatives

A family member or other authorized representative can request records on behalf of a patient, provided they present their own identification along with written authorization from the patient, where the patient is able to provide it. In cases where the patient cannot provide written authorization, such as a minor or a patient unable to communicate, the Medical Records Office follows a simplified verification process based on the relationship to the patient.

Request Submission and Processing Timeline

Record requests can be submitted in person at the Medical Records Office, by email, or by regular mail. Most standard administrative record requests are processed within five working days from the date the request and identification are received.

Request Type	Typical Processing Time
Copy of discharge summary	1 to 2 working days
Copy of billing statement	Same day, at the billing desk
Full administrative record	Up to 5 working days
Correction request	5 to 7 working days, for review

Digital and Printed Records

Patients can choose to receive their administrative record as a printed copy or, where available, as a digital copy sent to their registered email address. Requests for a digital copy should specify the preferred email address, which may need to be confirmed for security reasons.

Record Correction Requests

If a patient notices incorrect information in their administrative record, such as a misspelled name or an incorrect address, they can submit a correction request to the Medical Records Office. Correction requests are reviewed against the original registration information before being approved.

Missing Information and Document Collection

If part of a requested record is missing or incomplete, the Medical Records Office will inform the requester and provide the available information while continuing to look for any missing parts. Patients collecting a printed record in person should bring identification matching the original request.

Record Privacy

Patient administrative records are treated as private information and are only shared with the patient, an authorized representative, or hospital staff who need the information to provide administrative services. Records are not shared with outside parties without the patient's consent, except where the hospital's internal procedures specifically require it.

Record Retention

Administrative records are generally kept on file for a reasonable period after a patient's last visit, so that patients can request copies even some time after discharge. Patients needing a very old record are encouraged to contact the Medical Records Office directly, since retrieval time can vary for older records.

Where a record has been archived rather than kept in active storage, the Medical Records Office will let the requester know and provide a revised estimate for when the record can be made available.

Responsibilities

The Medical Records Office is responsible for verifying identity, processing record requests, and maintaining accurate administrative records. Patients and authorized representatives are responsible for providing accurate identification and completing the record request form.

Both the Medical Records Office and the requester share responsibility for accuracy: the office verifies details against what is on file, and the requester should promptly flag anything that looks incorrect once a record is received.

Exceptions

In urgent situations, such as a patient needing a discharge summary quickly for an appointment elsewhere, the Medical Records Office may expedite a request beyond the standard timeline, subject to identity verification still being completed.

Requests involving unusually old or incomplete records may take longer than the standard timeline, since additional time may be needed to locate archived information. The Medical Records Office will inform the requester if a longer timeline applies.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How can a patient request a copy of their records?

A: Patients should complete the hospital's record request form at the Medical Records Office or Administrative Services Desk and provide identification.

Q: What identification is needed for a record request?

A: A valid identification document matching the name on file is needed; authorized representatives also need their own identification and, where possible, written authorization from the patient.

Q: How can a patient request correction of an administrative record?

A: Patients can submit a correction request to the Medical Records Office, which reviews it against the original registration information before approving the change.

Q: How long does a record request take?

A: Most standard administrative record requests are processed within five working days, though some items, such as a discharge summary, may be available sooner.

Q: Can a family member request records on behalf of a patient?

A: Yes, if they present their own identification along with written authorization from the patient, where the patient is able to provide it.

Contact Information

For general questions about this policy, please contact the Administrative Services Desk.

Contact Point	Details
Administrative Services Desk	+1-555-010-2400
General Email	info@greenvalleyhospital.example
Hospital Address	25 Green Valley Road, Riverside District, New Harmony
Desk Hours	Monday to Saturday, 8:00 AM to 6:00 PM